

or sell it for a large sum of money. Therefore, it becomes important for businesses to protect the integrity and safety of their data.

Role of an Ethical Hacker

It's important that businesses be aware of different website hacking techniques and how they work. One way businesses can safeguard their data and protect their systems from getting hacked is by making use of an ethical hacker. Ethical hackers, also known as white cap hackers, are qualified people who can be deployed to test the business' network, the infrastructure and fill in the security vulnerabilities that are prone to attacks from hackers. Ethical hackers will deploy similar practices using tools that a hacker would use to identify the loopholes in a system. With the help of the data from ethical hackers, businesses can enhance the security to stay away from potential hacks.

So how does an ethical hacker identify the vulnerabilities in the business network and infrastructure? What follows is a deeper look into the different techniques used.

Discovering vulnerabilities in popular CMS and plugins

Most of the websites are built on top of Content Management Systems (CMSes). A CMS is a platform where web applications can be built and deployed quickly, and it also helps web administrators manage content effectively. A few of the most preferred CMS are WordPress, Drupal and Joomla. Each CMS system uses additional third-party plug-ins to help in effective content management.

According to statistics available at W3techs.com, WordPress dominates with 60.7% of the CMS market, with Joomla at 5.1% and Drupal at 3.3%. Given the dominance of CMSes, it's important to protect the CMS and the plug-ins from attacks. Vulnerability Scanners helps businesses and ethical hackers to scan the entire CMS for any potential loopholes or threat attacks. These scanners are pretty much similar to anti-virus software that keep our computers safe. There are lots of CMS scanners available for each CMS, and here we will list out the best vulnerability scanners for WordPress, Joomla and Drupal and how they can be used by ethical hackers to detect vulnerabilities.

a. SiteCheck by SUCURI (for WordPress)

SiteCheck is an online tool and a free website security scanner that thor-